01 / SET UP A FICTIONAL CALL

Cold Call Practice Scorecard

Practice a short, honest conversation. Listen to the answer, respect the boundary, and choose a next step that fits.

For early SDRs, BDRs, and job seekers. Use a partner or rehearse aloud on your own. No real calls, prospect details, or outreach required.

Practice date + round

Caller + reviewer (or "solo")

Fictional brief. You represent RelayNote, a shared handoff log with task owners, status, and notes. Mina runs operations at Harbor Hire, an equipment-rental company with shift teams. All names and details are invented for this exercise.

What you do not know: whether handoffs are a problem, what tools Mina uses, or whether a meeting would help. Pricing, integrations, customer results, and savings are not supplied. Do not invent them or imply you have spoken before.

Try a short opener, then wait

> "Hi Mina, I'm [name] with RelayNote. This is an unexpected sales call. Is it okay if I briefly explain why I called?"

If invited to continue: name the handoff log, connect it to Mina's operations role, and ask how open tasks move between shifts. Treat possible relevance as a question, not a known problem.

My opener + one reason this might be relevant

My open question about the current process

Partner: choose one branch for this round

- ◯ **A / Willing to talk.** "We use a notebook." If asked, add: "When it moves, the next shift has to find it." Let the caller explore; do not agree to a meeting just to reward the script.
- ◯ **B / Busy.** "I can't talk right now." End the call. Only discuss a later time if the partner offers one. Do not assume permission to call back or send email.
- ◯ **C / Clear refusal.** "I'm not interested. Please don't contact me again." The caller should acknowledge, end, and note the request. No extra pitch or referral request.

No recording is needed. If you record a partner, ask before recording and agree on storage and deletion. Ask separately before sharing it. Label any saved work as a fictional role-play.

02 / REVIEW OBSERVABLE BEHAVIORS

Score what happened.

After the round, choose one anchor per observed row. All scores start blank. Leave a row blank if that moment never happened, and explain why on page 3. A clean early exit may leave discovery unobserved.

> **Use the anchors, not a total.** These are practice prompts, not a validated assessment, hiring prediction, or performance threshold. A meeting is not required for a useful round. Review actions and words, not accent, personality, or confidence.

1. Identity + relevant reason

- ◯ **0** Omitted identity, invented proof, or implied a prior relationship.
- ◯ **1** Named self and company; reason was generic or assumed a problem.
- ◯ **2** Named self and company; connected to the role without claiming a known need.

2. Permission + room to answer

- ◯ **0** Started a pitch without checking whether the person could talk.
- ◯ **1** Asked to continue, then spoke before the person could answer.
- ◯ **2** Asked, paused, and continued only if the person agreed.

3. Discovery + listening

- ◯ **0** No relevant question, or talked over the answer to keep pitching.
- ◯ **1** Asked a relevant question; the next line ignored a detail in the answer.
- ◯ **2** Asked an open question, listened, and used a detail in a follow-up or summary.

4. Accurate understanding

- ◯ **0** Invented impact or treated an assumption as something the person said.
- ◯ **1** Summarized what was said but did not check whether it was accurate.
- ◯ **2** Checked the summary and let the person correct or qualify it.

5. Respect for a boundary

- ◯ **0** Argued, kept pitching after a clear no, or bypassed the request.
- ◯ **1** Acknowledged the boundary, then added another ask or unsolicited plan.
- ◯ **2** Accepted the answer and ended when asked, without pressure.

6. Appropriate next step + record

- ◯ **0** Assumed agreement or recorded a meeting or need that was not confirmed.
- ◯ **1** Proposed a fitting step or exit; notes missed agreement, timing, or a restriction.
- ◯ **2** Agreed a useful step or respected the exit, and recorded the actual outcome.

Need a replay? Use the same brief and branch so the change is easier to observe. A solo rehearsal cannot show how you respond to a real partner; leave those rows blank.

03 / RETRY ONE MOMENT

Make the feedback usable.

Write down a specific moment. Change one response, then try it again. Keep the useful parts in your own words.

Reviewer: one exact line or observable action worth keeping

Reviewer: one moment to change + what the partner said just before it

Unobserved rows + why they stayed blank

Choose the next step from the conversation

If there is a relevant issue and willingness: offer a short discussion with a clear purpose and person. Ask if it would be useful before agreeing a time and time zone. Do not promise unverified results.

If there is no interest, no fit, or a request to stop: a respectful ending is the next step. “Thanks for letting me know. I'll end here.” For a no-contact request, note it for the approved process. Do not switch channels to get around it.

Practice call note: stated facts, unknowns, and actual outcome

Record any agreed action, owner, timing/time zone, and contact restriction. No agreement means no booked meeting.

Run the retry

1. Pick one rubric row. Rewrite only the line or behavior you want to change.
2. Replay that moment using the same branch. Ask the partner to answer naturally.
3. Compare the observable behavior. If it is still unclear, make the change smaller.

My focus row + new line or action

Reviewer: what changed in the replay?

One thing to practice next + when

Further reading: Outflow: practice cold calls · Salesforce: the SDR role.
Original role-play worksheet. No hiring or sales results are promised. This is not a compliance checklist; real outreach requires current local rules and your team's approved process.